chief justice of Bangladesh who had become the president with Zia's blessings after the November 1975 coup, had discussions with a spy code-named Raja Man Singh and acknowledged that participation of the people was vital for the development of Bangladesh. Sayem's advisor Abdus Sattar also played a key role during the deliberations to allow a multi-party system.

Raja Man Singh said that Zia's intention was to neutralise all opponents before allowing any democratic and political movement in the country. After elevating Sayem as president, Zia had become chief martial law administrator and his first target was the JSD and its leaders.

'In the next four months, between December 1976 and March 1977, Zia played his game perfectly. The crackdown against dissidents was planned, calculated and executed with precision. Zia was also inspired by Sanjay Gandhi's family planning initiatives and tried to replicate the sterilisation model in Bangladesh. This did create some noise, but he subdued the protests against it. At around the same time, India held its first elections after the Emergency and the Indira Gandhi regime ended. The ripple effect was felt in the agency. The top echelon was removed by the new prime minister, Morarji Desai, and Suntook, who was closely involved with developments in Bangladesh, was appointed the new chief of R&AW,' recalled Raja Man Singh.

Abdus Sattar was appointed vice president of Bangladesh after the referendum in May 1977 and his main task was to float a political front for the military government. The Jatiy-atabadi Gantantrik Dal that emerged in February 1978 was the culmination of Sattar's effort to bring prominent figures of Bangladesh under a single political umbrella. The outfit was